

Containerization and Cloud-Native Applications: Transforming Modern Software Deployment

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Definitions

What is Containerization?

A method of packaging an application with all its code, libraries, and dependencies into a single lightweight, portable unit called a container — so it runs consistently across any environment.

What are Cloud-Native Apps?

Applications purpose-built to exploit cloud computing — designed as loosely-coupled microservices, packaged in containers, and dynamically orchestrated for elasticity, resilience, and rapid updates.

Containers vs. Virtual Machines

Aspect	Containers	Virtual Machines
OS	Share host OS kernel	Each VM runs full guest OS
Size	Megabytes – lightweight	Gigabytes – heavyweight
Startup	Seconds	Minutes
Isolation	Process-level	Full hardware-level
Density	Many per host	Fewer per host

Cloud-Native Architecture



Process Explanation

- Developer writes application code.
- Docker packages the application into a container.
- Container image is stored in Docker Hub.
- Kubernetes deploys and manages multiple containers.
- Cloud platform hosts the application.
- Users access the application through the internet

Benefits:

Advantages of Containerization

- Faster software deployment
- Better scalability
- High portability
- Lower infrastructure cost
- Efficient CPU and memory utilization
- Easy application updates
- High availability
- Faster disaster recovery

Industry Relevance



Netflix

Runs thousands of microservices in containers for global streaming



Spotify

Uses container orchestration to serve personalized music at scale



Google

Created Kubernetes; runs everything in containers internally



Amazon

Powers AWS and internal services with container platforms



Microsoft Azure

Offers managed Kubernetes (AKS) for enterprise cloud native apps

Netflix Container Deployment

Problem

- Millions of users watch movies simultaneously during weekends and holidays.

Solution

- Netflix packages its applications into Docker containers.
- Kubernetes automatically:
- Creates additional containers during heavy traffic.
- Removes unnecessary containers when traffic decreases.
- Maintains uninterrupted streaming.

Result

- High scalability
- Reduced downtime
- Better user experience
- Lower operational cost

Limitations and Future Scope

Limitations

- Security vulnerabilities
- Kubernetes complexity
- Monitoring multiple containers
- Persistent storage challenges
- Learning curve for beginners

Future Scope

- AI-based container orchestration
- Serverless containers
- Edge computing integration
- Green cloud computing
- Improved cloud security
- Intelligent auto-scaling

CONCLUSION

Containerization and cloud-native applications have transformed software deployment by making applications lightweight, portable, scalable, and highly reliable. Technologies like Docker and Kubernetes help organizations deploy applications faster while reducing infrastructure costs and improving performance .

KEYWORDS

- Containers package applications with all dependencies.
- Cloud-native applications are designed specifically for cloud platforms.
- Docker enables container creation.
- Kubernetes manages and scales containers automatically.
- Many global companies like Netflix, Google, and Amazon use containerization.
- Containerization is a key technology driving modern cloud computing and DevOps practices.